Silent Signal Cup 2026 Opens Team Registration as Hat Yai Prepares for a Visual-Cue Esports Final

Lomkhlai Esports Collective · Press Release Ref. LEC-PR-2026-09 · For immediate release, 1 October 2026

HAT YAI, Songkhla, 1 October 2026 – The Lomkhlai Esports Collective today opened team registration for the Silent Signal Cup 2026, a national tournament in the 5v5 team game *Pinwheel Siege* built around deaf and hard-of-hearing players. The tournament replaces voice communication with visual signals, on-screen captions and Thai Sign Language at every stage, from the online qualifiers to the live final on stage in Hat Yai.

The Silent Signal Cup started in 2025 as a one-day invitational for eight teams from the southern provinces. After strong interest from players in Khon Kaen, Chiang Mai and Bangkok, the 2026 edition is open to teams from anywhere in Thailand and has grown to a field of up to 32 teams.

1. The tournament at a glance

- Game: *Pinwheel Siege*, 5v5, played on the current competitive patch announced on 1 November 2026.
- Online qualifiers: 7 to 22 November 2026, played on weekends only, best-of-one group matches followed by best-of-three play-offs.
- Live finals: Saturday 12 and Sunday 13 December 2026 in the Sea Breeze Hall on level 4 of the Lomkhlai Arena building, Thanon Niphat Uthit 2, Hat Yai. The top four teams from the qualifiers play the finals.
- Field size: up to 32 teams. If more than 32 complete teams register, places are allocated in the order in which the entry fee was received.
- Prize pool: 480,000 baht in total. The winning team receives 240,000 baht, the runner-up 120,000 baht, and the teams in third and fourth place 60,000 baht each. The 2025 invitational had a prize pool of 150,000 baht.

2. Who can enter

Each team registers a roster of five starting players and up to two substitutes. At least three of the five players on the server in any match must be deaf or hard of hearing; the remaining two may be hearing players. This is a change from the 2025 invitational, where all five starters had to be deaf or hard of hearing. Teams told the organisers that the old rule made it hard to keep a roster together, and many mixed groups of friends wanted to play together.

Players confirm their status by signing a Hearing Status Declaration in the registration portal. No audiogram, medical report or disability card is required, and the organisers do not keep any medical information. All players must be at least 16 years old on 7 November 2026. Players aged 16 or 17 must upload a guardian consent form signed by a parent or legal guardian.

> **Note.** A player may appear on only one Silent Signal Cup roster. Coaches do not count towards the five starters or two substitutes, and each team may name one coach, who may be hearing or deaf.

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3. How the visual-cue rules work

Voice chat is switched off for all players during every official match, online and on stage. Teams communicate through in-game pings, the text panel, and sign language between players at the booth. Coaches may sign to players only during the draft phase and between maps, never while a round is live.

Booth light signals

During the live finals, each team booth has a light bar above the monitors that replaces the referee's spoken calls:

- Steady amber: a pause has been requested and will start at the end of the current round.
- Steady red: the match is paused; players must take their hands off the keyboard and mouse.
- Flashing green: play resumes in 10 seconds.
- Flashing blue: a technical pause has been called by one of the teams.

In the online qualifiers the same signals appear as coloured banners in the referee's match lobby. Each team has two tactical pauses of up to 60 seconds per map. Technical pauses have no fixed limit, but the referee on duty decides whether a technical problem is genuine and when play continues.

Interpreters and captions

Six Thai Sign Language interpreters will work on rotation during the finals, changing every 20 minutes. Two interpreters stand at the side of the stage for the players, and one appears in a picture-in-picture window on the broadcast. All casting on the stream carries live captions in Thai and English, prepared by a captioning team working with a delay of about 4 seconds.

4. How to register a team

Registration is open from 6 October 2026 until 23:59 on 25 October 2026. The team captain completes the following steps on the Lomkhlai registration portal:

1. Create a team account and choose a team name. Names are checked by the organisers and may be refused if they are offensive or copy a sponsor's brand.
2. Enter the roster: the in-game ID, full name and province of each of the five starters and any substitutes.
3. Ask every player to sign the Hearing Status Declaration from the link sent to their own email. The captain cannot sign for other players.
4. Upload a guardian consent form for any player aged 16 or 17.
5. Pay the entry fee by bank transfer and upload the transfer slip. The fee is 1,500 baht per team, or 1,000 baht per team for early-bird payments received by 15 October 2026.
6. Wait for the confirmation email, which is sent within 3 working days once all declarations and the fee have been received.
7. Attend the compulsory online rules briefing on Sunday 1 November 2026 at 19:00, delivered in Thai Sign Language with Thai and English captions. At least three players from each team must attend.

A team that has not completed every declaration by the closing date will not receive a place, even if the entry fee has been paid. In that case the fee is refunded in full within 14 days.

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5. Travel support for finalists

The four finalist teams receive hotel accommodation in Hat Yai for three nights, from 11 to 14 December 2026, for up to seven people per team (five players, one substitute and the coach). Finalist teams based outside Songkhla province also receive a travel grant of 12,000 baht per team, paid by bank transfer before 4 December 2026. The travel grant is paid in addition to any prize money and does not have to be returned. Teams from Songkhla province receive the hotel rooms but not the travel grant.

6. Finals weekend for spectators

Entry to the Sea Breeze Hall is free, but spectators must reserve a seat in advance. The hall has 400 seats, including 60 seats in the front rows kept for deaf and hard-of-hearing spectators with a clear view of the stage interpreters. Doors open at 10:00 on both days and the first match starts at 11:00. Spectators are encouraged to use visual applause, raising both hands and shaking them, so that players can see the reaction of the crowd from the booths.

Spectators who need assistive equipment, such as a vibrating wristband linked to the in-hall sound system or a seat close to the caption screen, can request it when they book their seat.

7. Who to contact

- Tournament Director, Pimchanok Rerkrai: overall running of the tournament, sponsorship, and payment of prize money and travel grants.
- Head Referee, Arthit Chanthep: match rulings, pauses, penalties and disputes. A team that wants to appeal a ruling must send a written appeal to the Head Referee within 15 minutes after the end of the map concerned.
- Accessibility Lead, Wilaiwan Muangkaew: interpreter bookings, captioning, and requests from players for assistive equipment at the finals, such as vibrating wristbands or a personal interpreter in the team warm-up room. Player requests must reach her by 20 November 2026.
- Registration desk: questions about the portal, declarations and entry fee payments.

"Last year we proved that a deaf team can play at the highest level without saying a word," said Pimchanok Rerkrai, Tournament Director. "This year we want every province to send a team, and we want hearing players to learn that our visual signals make the game clearer for everyone."

About the Lomkhlai Esports Collective

The Lomkhlai Esports Collective is a non-profit community group founded in Hat Yai in 2022. It runs grassroots tournaments, coaching nights and accessible gaming sessions for players in southern Thailand, and has organised the Silent Signal Cup since its first edition in 2025.

Media contact: Korawit Sombatsiri, Communications Officer, Lomkhlai Esports Collective. Media requests for interviews with players should be made by 30 November 2026; interviews with deaf players are arranged with an interpreter present.

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